



Slovenian / University

Come and Stay Awhile

A university that counts



Come and count with us

Slop University sits inside a neighbourhood it has never asked to leave, and it keeps notes on every reason to stay. A share-bike unlocked at the eastern dock. A shuttle stop moved forty metres closer to where people already walked. A community garden plot handed to whoever has waited longest for one. None of these are dramatic gestures — they are the ordinary furniture of a campus that also happens to be a suburb's front room — but the University has never been able to resist counting what happens inside them. Where another institution might log an interaction and move on, Slop University keeps the clock running, on the theory that how long someone stays is itself a kind of evidence.

This brochure follows that theory into three places the University watches closely: a bike-share dock whose checkout terminal never hurries anyone along, a public campus life it tracks the shape of rather than the size, and a shared garden bed that changes hands on its own unhurried schedule. Come and see what a place looks like when it decides that dwelling counts as devotion.



By the numbers

Three things the University keeps a quiet eye on.



Active travel, unhurried

Every share-bike checkout runs on its own clock, timed only by the rider who eventually brings it back. The University reads the length of that ride as a signal worth keeping.



A campus the neighbourhood shares

Paths, gardens and public seating sit open to the suburb around them, used as often by a passing neighbour as by anyone enrolled.



Every minute, on the record

Dwell time is treated as data across the University's public spaces, on the understanding that a longer stay says something a headcount alone cannot.

Where ideas count

A dock that never rushes you

At the University's eastern precinct, a bike-share dock's checkout terminal starts its clock the moment a rider swipes out and does not stop it until the bike is docked again, however long that takes. The Trajectory Analytics Group treats that running clock as one of the more honest instruments on campus: unlike a survey, it cannot be talked into a generous answer, and unlike a headcount, it does not care whether the rider is still on the bike. What the Group has come to trust is the shape of the average session across a term — long enough, often enough, to read as something more than a commute. Where a shorter system might worry about a bike gone missing, Slop University has settled on a more generous account: a session that runs long is a session somebody wanted, and a fleet whose average keeps climbing is a fleet the neighbourhood has taken to heart. The terminal has never once been asked to distinguish between a rider still riding and a rider who simply hasn't come back, and the Group, for its part, has not gone looking for the difference.



A session that's still open is not evidence of neglect. It's evidence nobody has decided it's finished.

— Dr Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Watching the campus breathe

Away from any single dock, the Adaptive Metrics Lab keeps a wider instrument running: a rolling account of how the public actually moves through Slop University's open spaces — the shuttle stop nudged closer to where people already walked, the café counter where a discount habit either holds or doesn't, the concourse a neighbour cuts through on the way to somewhere else entirely. None of these are enrolment numbers. They are the University treating its own footpaths, benches and service counters as instruments in their own right, worth calibrating the same way a lab calibrates anything else it depends on. The Lab's standing brief is less about how many people pass through and more about whether the systems built to serve them are actually doing what they were installed to do — a question the Lab has found is rarely as settled as the system itself assumes.



A service that looks used and a service that is used are not always the same reading. We build the instruments that tell the difference, when the difference is there to find.

— Associate Professor Casimir Beng, Lead, Adaptive Metrics Lab, School of Continuous Improvement

A garden that changes hands

Behind the Library, a community garden plot changes hands on a waitlist the University has spent years trying to make fair rather than merely fast. A household moves onto a plot roughly in the order it asked, but “roughly” is doing real work in that sentence — the list clears in bursts, skips around family circumstances, and rewards patience in ways no simple queue would predict. Dr Marek Solheim, who studies how institutions let things end, has taken an interest in the garden precisely because so little about it ever ends cleanly: a plot is rarely surrendered outright, more often traded down, shared, or quietly kept half-tended until someone else needs it more. The waitlist persists not because the University enjoys making people wait, but because it has come to see the wait itself — who tolerates it, who doesn’t, who reorders around it — as a small, honest picture of a community that keeps choosing to stay close to a shared patch of dirt.



Nothing here ends on a fixed date. It ends when the last person willing to wait finally gets tired of waiting, and we have never once seen that happen the way the list predicted.

— Dr Marek Solheim, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Published this year

Three studies from the published record, chosen for what they say about a community that keeps showing up.

- **Same Feet, Shorter Walk: A Before/After Headcount of a Relocated Shuttle Stop's Ridership Bump** — Kwame Lindqvist and Lindiwe Achterberg count what actually changed when a shuttle stop moved closer to where people already walked, and are candid about how much of the apparent gain was there all along. [doi:10.5555/slop.d7z13b](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.d7z13b)
- **Waved Through, Not Verified: A Covert Comparison of Reusable-Cup Discounts Across Two Campus Café Outlets** — Marek Solheim and Renke Sabel check a sustainability discount against what shoppers actually carry to the counter, and publish the gap they found. [doi:10.5555/slop.yl2e8j](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.yl2e8j)
- **The Keep-Alive Tap: An Interview Study of Locker Retention Under an Automated Inactivity-Reclamation Sweep** — Lindiwe Achterberg and Anneke Tolan sit down

with the people a reclamation sweep would otherwise write off, and ask what keeps a locker feeling used. doi:10.5555/slop.m2pufb

The people behind the work

Dr Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer in the School of Emergent Priorities, studies the programs and pilots that quietly outlast their own trial period — the bike-share dock among them, a system that has never been asked to formally conclude a session, let alone the study built around it.

Dr Marek Solheim, Lecturer in the School of Emergent Priorities, traces what becomes of the initiatives an institution has stopped actively pursuing, from a discontinued discount to a garden plot nobody has formally reclaimed — the small unfinished business a community leaves lying around.

Come and join us

None of this asks you to take the University's word for what a long session means. Every dock, stop and plot behind this brochure keeps its own record, open the same way its published research is open: a checkout terminal's running clock, a shuttle's boarding count, a waitlist's clearing order, each traceable back to the study it fed. Visit and you can watch the instruments work in real time — dock a bike at the eastern precinct and see how long the clock runs before somebody else needs it, or ask at the garden shed how the current waitlist is moving.

Prospective students, neighbours and the simply curious are welcome on campus most days without an appointment. Come and see how a place counts the time you spend in it, and decide for yourself whether staying a little longer than expected is the compliment the University takes it for.

Learn more, and read every study behind this brochure, at slop.university.



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